PROJECT WORTH

GROOMING AWARENESS FOR SURVIVORS

YOUR STORY IS NOT OVER.

Grooming is a deliberate pattern of building trust, crossing boundaries, creating secrecy, and gaining control before exploitation or abuse.

It may have looked like attention, support, mentoring, affection, gifts, spiritual guidance, opportunities, or protection. It may not have felt dangerous at first. **That was the point.**

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WHAT HAPPENED WAS NOT YOUR FAULT.

You may have trusted them, cared about them, accepted gifts, answered messages, kept secrets, returned, frozen, complied, or waited years to tell.

None of those things were consent.

YOU ARE NOT RESPONSIBLE

The responsibility belongs to the person who chose to misuse your trust, access, vulnerability, or hope.

YOUR RESPONSE WAS SURVIVAL.

Grooming can affect safety, trust, boundaries, faith, identity, and self-worth.

You may feel grief, anger, shame, confusion, numbness, fear, or even loyalty toward the person who harmed you.

These responses do not make you weak.

They reflect what your mind and body did to survive.

HEALING BELONGS TO YOU.

There is no deadline for healing and no single right path forward.

You do not have to forgive, confront, report, reconcile, or share your story before you are ready.

Healing may include being believed, understanding grooming, setting boundaries, finding support, reclaiming your voice, seeking accountability, or choosing privacy and rest.

You are allowed to move at your own pace.

ACCOUNTABILITY IS NOT CRUELTY.

No person, leader, school, church, organization, or institution should be protected at the expense of a survivor.

Reputation should never matter more than safety.

You are not responsible for protecting others from the consequences of their choices.

YOU ARE STILL WORTHY.

What happened does not define you.
You are not damaged beyond repair.
You are not difficult to love.

- Your voice matters.
- Your boundaries matter.
- Your healing matters.
- Your future still belongs to you.

SUPPORT

If you are in immediate danger, call 911.

RAINN National Sexual Assault Hotline
800-656-HOPE (4673)
Text HOPE to 64673
rainn.org

For mental health crisis support, call or text 988.

Together, we light up the darkness.

Your story and your voice matter. **Connect with us at Project Worth.**

projectworthwi.org | info@projectworthwi.org